“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 4

Relishing the Life of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

1 I bow down to Mādhavendra Purī, for whose sake Gopīnātha stole a pot of sweet rice and so became known as Kṣīra-corā, “the thief of sweet rice”, and conquered by whose love Śrī Gopāla revealed Himself.[1]

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![2]

3–4 The Lord’s coming to Nīlādri, His seeing Jagannātha, His meeting with Sārvabhauma Bhaṭṭācārya — all these pastimes Śrī Vṛndāvana dāsa has described in detail, and his description is excellent.[3]

5 The pastimes of Caitanya are by their very nature wonderful and sweet, and from the lips of Vṛndāvana dāsa they flow as a stream of nectar.

6 Therefore to describe them again would be mere repetition; and should I presume to describe them out of pride, I have no such power.

7 So I shall only touch briefly upon the pastimes he described in the *Caitanya-maṅgala*.[4]

8 As best I can, I shall tell those pastimes he mentioned in his summary but did not describe.

9 Therefore I bow down at his feet, praying that I may not offend him.

10 In this way Mahāprabhu went on towards Nīlācala with four devotees, joyfully singing the kīrtana of Kṛṣṇa.

11 One day He went to a village for alms and Himself begged and brought back a great deal of food.

12 On the way the many powerful ferrymen at the crossings did not hinder Him; bestowing His mercy on them all, He came to Remuṇā.[5]

13 In Remuṇā the Lord, full of devotion, took darśana of the supremely enchanting Gopīnātha.[6]

14 As the Lord bowed down near His lotus feet, Gopīnātha's crown of flowers fell onto His head.

15 Receiving the crown, Mahāprabhu was filled with joy, and with His devotees He danced and sang at length.

16 Seeing the Lord's majesty, His love, His beauty and His qualities, the servants of Gopīnātha were struck with wonder.

17 Lovingly they served the Lord in many ways, and the Lord spent that night there.

18 The Lord stayed there out of eagerness for the mahā-prasāda of sweet rice, for Īśvara Purī had once told Him its story.[7]

19 His famous name is “Kṣīra-corā Gopīnātha”, and the Lord told the devotees the story behind it.

20 Long ago He stole sweet rice for Mādhava Purī, and so He came to be called “Kṣīra-corā Hari”, Hari the thief of sweet rice.[89]

21 Once Śrī Mādhava Purī came to Vṛndāvana, and wandering on and on, he reached Govardhana.

22 Mad with love, he could not tell night from day. Now he would rise, now he would fall, with no thought of where he was.

23 After walking around the hill, he came to Govinda-kuṇḍa and bathed there, and in the evening he sat beneath a tree.[10]

24 A cowherd boy came carrying a pot of milk. Holding it out before him, He smiled and said:

25 “Purī, take this milk and drink it. Why do you not beg for food and eat? What are you meditating on?”

26 Purī was delighted by the boy’s beauty, and at His sweet words his hunger and thirst vanished.[11]

27 Purī said, “Who are You? Where do You live? How did You know that I was fasting?”

28 The boy said, “I am a cowherd and live in this village. In My village no one goes hungry.[12]

29 Some beg for food and eat, and some live on milk; but to one who does not beg I Myself give food.

30 The women who came to fetch water saw you, and they have given Me milk and sent Me to you.

31 I must go now to milk the cows, but I will come back and take this pot."

32 Saying this, the boy went away and was seen no more, and Mādhava Purī's heart was filled with wonder.[13]

33 He drank the milk, washed the pot and set it aside. He kept watching the path, but the boy did not come back.[14]

34 Purī sat chanting the Name, and no sleep came to him. At the end of the night a trance came over him, and his outward senses were stilled.[15]

35 In a dream he saw that same boy come before him, take him by the hand and lead him into a grove.

36 Pointing to the grove, He said, "This is where I stay, and I suffer greatly from cold and rain, wind and heat.

37 Bring the people of the village and take Me out of the grove. Carry Me up the hill and settle Me there with care.[16]

38 Build a temple there and install Me in it, and bathe My body with plenty of cool water.

39 For many days I have been watching the path for you, Mādhava, wondering when you would come and serve Me.[17]

40 Conquered by your love, I shall accept your service, and by giving My darśana I shall deliver the whole world.

41 My name is Śrī Gopāla; I am the Holder of Govardhana. I was installed by Vajra, and I am the master here.[18]

42 In fear of the *mlecchas* My servant brought Me down from the top of the hill, hid Me in this grove and fled.

43 Since then I have stayed in this grove. It is good that you have come; take Me out carefully."

44 Saying this, the boy disappeared. Mādhava Purī woke up and began to reflect.

45 "I saw Śrī Kṛṣṇa, but I could not recognise Him!" Saying this, he fell to the ground, overwhelmed with love.

46 He wept for a while; then, to carry out the command, he steadied his mind.

47 After his morning bath Purī went into the village, gathered all the people together and said:[19]

48 "The Lord of your village, the Holder of Govardhana, is in the grove. Come, let us bring Him out.

49 Take axes and spades to clear a way, for the grove is so dense that we cannot get in."

50 Hearing this, the people joyfully went with him. Cutting through the thicket, they made a way and entered.

51 They found the Deity covered with earth and grass, and at the sight all the people were amazed and overjoyed.

52 They cleared away the covering and the Deity came into view. He was immensely heavy, and no one could move Him.

53 Gathering the very strongest men, Purī took the Deity up to the top of the hill.

54 They seated the Deity on a throne of stone, and set a large stone behind Him for support.

55 All the brāhmaṇas of the village took new pots and brought strained water from Govinda-kuṇḍa.[20]

56 Nine hundred pots of water were brought. Instruments and drums of every kind resounded, and the women sang.

57 Some sang and some danced; it became a great festival. All the yogurt, milk and ghee in the village was brought.

58 Food for the offering came, *sandeśa* and sweets of every kind, and so many other gifts that I cannot describe them all.

59 Tulasī, flowers and cloth came in abundance, and Mādhava Purī himself performed the bathing ceremony (*abhiṣeka*).

60 Removing the dirt from His body, he bathed Him, and with plenty of oil he made the holy body glisten.[21]

61 He bathed Him with *pañca-gavya* and *pañcāmṛta*, and then performed the great bath (*mahā-snāna*) with a hundred pots of water.[22]

62 Again he made the holy body glisten with oil, and completed the bath with fragrant water poured from a conch.[23]

63 Wiping the holy body dry, he dressed Him and adorned Him with sandal paste, tulasī and garlands of flowers.

64 He presented incense and a lamp, and then offered many kinds of food — yogurt, milk, sweets and everything else that had been brought.

65 He set out fragrant water in new vessels, and after giving water to rinse the mouth (*ācamana*), he offered betel (*tāmbūla*).

66 After the *ārati* he recited many prayers, and, falling prostrate like a rod, he surrendered himself to Him.

67 The villagers brought all the rice, *dāl* and wheat flour in the village, until the hilltop was full.

68 All the earthen pots in the potters' houses were brought, and in the morning the cooking began.

69 Ten brāhmaṇas cooked rice and piled it into a great heap, while some five others cooked vegetable dishes and many kinds of soup.[24]

70 From wild greens, fruits and roots they made dishes of every kind, and some of the brāhmaṇas made *baḍā*, *baḍi* and *kaḍi*.

71 Five or seven people made flatbreads (*ruṭi*) in heaps upon heaps, and all the rice and vegetables were swimming in ghee.

72 They spread new cloth and laid *palāśa* leaves on it, and as the rice was cooked, they heaped it up on top.

73 Beside it rose a mountain of flatbreads, and pots of soup and vegetables were set all around.

74 Next to these they set out yogurt, milk, buttermilk, *śikhariṇī*, sweet rice, fresh butter and cream.[25]

75 In this way the Annakūṭa, the mountain of food, was arranged, and Purī Gosāñi offered it to Gopāla.[26]

76 Many pots were filled with fragrant water and offered, and Gopāla, hungry after so many days, ate everything.

77 Although Gopāla ate all the rice and vegetables, by the touch of His hand everything became full again, just as before.[27]

78 Mādhava Gosāñi perceived this, for nothing of Gopāla's is hidden from him.[28]

79 Such a festival was held after only a single day's preparation. It came about by Gopāla's power, but no one else knew it.

80 After giving water to rinse the mouth, he offered betel rolls in plenty; then he performed *ārati*, and the people cried, "Jaya! Jaya!"[29]

81 He had a bed prepared: a new cot was brought, and new cloth was spread over it.

82 The four sides were enclosed with screens of grass, and one screen was placed on top as a roof.

83 Purī Gosāñi told all the brāhmaṇas, "Feed all the people of the village, from the children to the old."

84 Everyone sat down and ate in turn; the brāhmaṇas and their wives were fed first.

85 Everyone who came from other villages to look on saw Gopāla and received prasāda as well.

86 Seeing Purī's power, the people were amazed: it was as if the Annakūṭa of old had come before their eyes.[30]

87 Purī made all the brāhmaṇas Vaiṣṇavas and engaged each of them in one service or another.[31]

88 At the close of the day he had the Lord woken again, offered Him a little food and gave Him water to drink.

89 The word spread through the land: "Gopāla has appeared!" And people from all the villages around came to see Him.

90 Each village asked for a day of its own, and all of them joyfully held the Annakūṭa.

91 At night, after putting the Deity to rest, Purī Gosāñi would take a little milk.[32]

92 In the morning the service went on again in the same way, and the people of another village came, bringing food.

93 The people brought all the grain, ghee, yogurt and milk there was in their village and set it before Gopāla.

94 The brāhmaṇas cooked as on the day before, and Gopāla ate the Annakūṭa in the same way.

95 The people of Vraja have a natural love for Kṛṣṇa, and Gopāla has a natural love for the people of Vraja.[33]

96 Everyone came and ate the mahā-prasāda, and seeing Gopāla, they were all freed from sorrow and grief.

97 All the people of the surrounding land of Vraja held the great festival, each on a day of their own.

98 Hearing that Gopāla had appeared, people began to come from many lands, bringing all kinds of gifts.

99 All the great and wealthy people of Mathurā brought gifts of every kind and offered them with devotion.

100 Gold, silver, cloth, fragrances and gifts of food came in countless numbers, and the storehouse grew day by day.

101 A very wealthy kṣatriya had a temple built; someone built the kitchen and storehouse, and someone else the surrounding wall.

102 Every Vrajavāsī gave a cow, and Gopāla came to have ten thousand cows.

103 Two renounced brāhmaṇas came from Gauḍa, and Purī Gosāñi kept them with him, caring for them affectionately.[34]

104 He made those two his disciples and entrusted the service to them. The Deity was now served in royal style, and Purī's joy grew.

105 In this way he served for two years. Then one day Purī Gosāñi had a dream.

106 Gopāla said, "Purī, My heat does not go away. Anoint Me with sandal paste from the Malaya hills, and then it will cool.[35]

107 Go and bring the Malaya sandal from Nīlācala. No one else can do this — set out quickly!”

108 Seeing this dream, Purī Gosāñi was overwhelmed with love, and to carry out the Lord’s order he set out for the eastern land.

109 He appointed people to carry on the service and, begging leave of the Deity, set out for the land of Gauḍa.

110 He came to Śāntipura, to the house of Advaitācārya. Seeing Purī’s love, the Ācārya felt bliss within.

111 The Ācārya eagerly received the mantra from him, and Purī, having initiated Him, went on to the south.[36]

112 In Remuṇā he had darśana of Gopīnātha, and the sight of His beauty overwhelmed his heart.

113 After dancing and singing he sat down in the *jagamohana* and asked the brāhmaṇa, “What offerings are made to the Deity?”

114 Seeing the excellence of the service, he was joyful at heart and concluded that the finest offerings must be made here.

115 “I shall learn all that is offered here, and then I can offer the like to Gopāla.”

116 For this reason he questioned the brāhmaṇa, and the brāhmaṇa described all the offerings in detail.

117 “In the evening sweet rice called ‘Amṛta-keli’ is offered. It fills twelve earthen pots and is just like nectar.

118 It is famous as ‘Gopīnātha’s kṣīra’, and nowhere else in the world is there such an offering.”

119 Just then that very offering was set before the Deity. Hearing of it, Purī Gosāñi thought to himself:

120 “If, without my asking, I could get a little of this sweet-rice prasāda, I would know its taste and could offer the same to Gopāla.”

121 Ashamed of this desire, he remembered Viṣṇu. Meanwhile the offering came to an end, and the music of the ārati began.[37]

122 Purī watched the ārati, offered his obeisance and went out, without saying anything more to anyone.

123 Purī lived on whatever came unasked. Detached and indifferent to the world, he ate if food came of itself, and otherwise he fasted.[38]

124 He was satisfied by the nectar of love, and hunger and thirst did not trouble him. He counted it an offence that a desire for sweet rice had arisen in him.

125 He sat in the deserted marketplace of the village and sang kīrtana. Meanwhile the pūjārī laid the Deity to rest.[39]

126 When he had finished his own duties, the pūjārī lay down to sleep, and in a dream the Deity came and spoke to him:

127 “Get up, pūjārī, and open the door! I have kept back one pot of sweet rice for a sannyāsī.

128 One pot of sweet rice is there, covered by the edge of My cloth; by My own māyā none of you noticed it.

129 A sannyāsī named Mādhava Purī is sitting in the marketplace. Take this sweet rice to him at once."

130 After this dream the pūjārī got up and pondered it. Then he bathed, unbolted the doors and opened the temple.

131 Beneath the edge of the Deity's cloth he found the sweet rice. He cleansed the spot, took the pot and came out.

132 Closing the door, he went into the village with the sweet rice and wandered from market to market, looking for Mādhava Purī.

133 "Let whoever is named Mādhava Purī come and take this sweet rice! Gopīnātha has stolen it for you.

134 Take it and eat it happily. In the three worlds there is no one as fortunate as you!"

135 Hearing this, Purī Gosāñi made himself known. The pūjārī gave him the sweet rice and fell flat before him like a rod.

136 The pūjārī told him the story of the sweet rice, and as he listened, Śrī Mādhava Purī was overcome with love.

137 Seeing his love, the servant said in amazement, "No wonder Kṛṣṇa is under his sway!"

138 With these words he bowed and went away, and Purī ate the sweet rice in ecstasy.[40]

139 He washed the pot, broke it into pieces and kept the shards tied in his outer cloth.

140 Every day he ate one piece, and each time he ate it he was overwhelmed with love — a wonderful tale!

141 "When people hear that the Deity gave me sweet rice," he thought, "my name will spread, and by day crowds will gather."[41]

142 Fearing this, Śrī Purī bowed down to Gopīnātha right there and set out at the end of the night.

143 Walking on and on, Purī came to Śrī Nīlācala, and when he saw Jagannātha he was overwhelmed with love.

144 In the ecstasy of love he would rise and fall, laugh, dance and sing. The sight of Jagannātha filled him with great joy.

145 The news spread among the people: "Mādhava Purī Śrīpāda has come!" Everyone came and showed him great devotion.[42]

146 This is the nature of fame, as all the world knows: Providence brings it to the one who does not desire it.[43]

147 For fear of fame Purī kept running away, yet together with his love for Kṛṣṇa, fame came rolling after him.

148 Though he grew uneasy and wished to flee, the task of procuring sandalwood for the Deity held him bound.[44]

149 To all the servants of Jagannātha and all the great devotees he told the whole story of Gopāla.

150 When the devotees heard that Gopāla was asking for sandalwood, they joyfully set about obtaining it.

151 Those who knew the king's officers begged from them, and so the camphor and sandalwood were gathered.[45]

152 To carry the sandalwood they sent a brāhmaṇa and a servant with Purī Gosāñi, and gave money for the journey as well.

153 So that the toll-collectors and the ferrymen would let him pass, they had the king's officers write a royal letter and placed it in Purī Gosāñi's hand.[46]

154 Mādhava Purī set out with the sandalwood, and after some days he reached Remuṇā.

155 At the feet of Gopīnātha he bowed down again and again, and in the ecstasy of love he danced and sang without end.

156 Seeing Purī, all the servants received him with honour and fed him with sweet-rice prasāda.

157 That night he slept in the temple, and towards the end of the night Purī had a dream.

158 Gopāla came and said, "Listen, Mādhava: I have received all the camphor and sandalwood.[47]

159 Grind all this sandalwood together with the camphor and smear it on the body of Gopīnātha.[48]

160 Gopīnātha's body and Mine are one and the same. If you give Him sandalwood, My heat will abate.

161 Do not hesitate or harbour any doubt. Trust My word and give Him the sandalwood."

162 With these words Gopāla went away, and Gosāñi awoke. He called the servants of Gopīnātha together and told them:

163 "The Lord has given His order: smear this camphor and sandalwood on Gopīnātha's body every day.

164 If you give Him sandalwood, Gopāla will be cooled. The Lord is independent, and His order must prevail."

165 Hearing that Gopīnātha would wear sandalwood throughout the hot season, the servants were delighted at heart.

166 Purī said, "These two will grind the sandalwood. Give two more men as well, and I shall pay their wages."

167 In this way the sandalwood was ground and offered every day, and all the servants joyfully smeared it on the Deity.

168 Every day the Deity wore sandalwood until it was all used up, and all that time Purī stayed there.

169 At the end of the hot season he went back to Nīlācala and joyfully spent the Cāturmāsya there.

170 With His own holy lips the Lord told the devotees the nectarean story of Mādhava Purī, and relished it Himself.[49]

171 The Lord said, “Consider, Nityānanda: there is no one in the world as fortunate as Purī.

172 On the pretext of bringing him milk, Kṛṣṇa showed Himself to him, and three times He came to him in dreams to give him His orders.

173 Won over by his love, Kṛṣṇa appeared, and by accepting his service He delivered the world.

174 For his sake Gopīnātha stole sweet rice, and so He came to be called Kṣīra-corā, “the thief of sweet rice”.

175 When camphor and sandalwood were put on His body, Purī Gosāñi’s love overflowed with joy.

176 To bring camphor and sandalwood through the land of the *mlecchas* would be full of trouble, and Gopāla knew that Purī would suffer.[50]

177 The Lord is supremely merciful and loving to His devotees: by wearing the sandalwood, He made His devotee’s labour bear fruit.

178 Consider the utmost limit of Purī’s love! This love, not of this world, fills the heart with wonder.[51]

179 He was supremely detached, silent and indifferent to everything, and for fear of worldly talk he kept no companion.[52]

180 Yet such a man, receiving Gopāla’s nectarean order, travelled a thousand *krośas* and went about begging for sandalwood.[53]

181 He would rather stay hungry than beg for food to eat, and such a man went on his way carrying a load of sandalwood.

182 He carried about a maund of sandalwood and some twenty *tolās* of camphor, and the thought “I shall put them on Gopāla!” filled him with joy.[54]

183 When a ferryman in Utkala saw the sandalwood, he held Purī back, but Purī got free by showing the royal letter.[55]

184 In the land of the *mlecchas* the road was long and the watchmen on it were countless, yet he never stopped to think how he would get the sandalwood through.[56]

185 He had not a single cowrie with him to pay the tolls, yet he was full of eagerness to carry the sandalwood on.

186 Such is the natural way of deep love: it takes no account of its own sufferings, obstacles and the like.[57]

187 It was to show the world this deep love of his that Gopāla ordered him to bring sandalwood.

188 With great labour he brought the sandalwood to Remuṇā, yet the joy in his heart only grew, and he counted the hardship as nothing.

189 Gopāla gave him this order to test him, and when He had tested him, at last He showed His mercy.[58]

190 Such is this devotion, and such are the dealings of Kṛṣṇa, who loves His devotees; none of us is qualified even to understand them.”[59]

191 Saying this, the Lord recited the verse that Purī composed, a verse that like the moon has lit up the whole world.

192 Just as the finest Malaya sandal grows more fragrant the more it is rubbed, so does this verse the more one ponders it.[60]

193 As the Kaustubha gem is among jewels, so I count this verse among all poetry of rasa.

194 This verse was spoken by Śrī Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī Herself; by Her mercy it shone forth as the words of Mādhavendra.

195 Besides them, only Gauracandra relishes it; there is no fourth person who can taste it.[61]

196 At the end of his life Purī recited this verse again and again, and with this verse he attained perfection.

197 "O Lord, melting with compassion for the wretched! O Lord of Mathurā, when shall I see You? My heart, stricken at not seeing You, has lost all rest. O Beloved, what am I to do?" (Padyāvalī, 400)[62]

198 As He recited this verse, the Lord fainted. Overpowered by love, He fell to the ground.

199 Nityānanda hastily took Him on His lap, and then Gauracandra rose, weeping.

200 The madness of love seized Him. Rising, He ran here and there, roaring, laughing, weeping, dancing and singing.

201 Again and again He said, "Ayi dīna, ayi dīna!" No other words would leave His throat, and tears streamed from His eyes.

202 Trembling and perspiration, hair standing on end and tears, stupor and pallor; despondency, dejection, bewilderment, pride, joy and humility — all these appeared in Him.[63]

203 With this verse the Lord threw open the doors of love, and the servants of Gopīnātha watched Him dance in the grip of love.

204 Seeing the crowd of people, the Lord came back to outward awareness. The Deity's offering was over, and the music of the ārati began.

205 The pūjārī laid the Deity to rest and came out. He brought the prasāda, all twelve pots of sweet rice, and set them before the Lord.

206 At the sight of the sweet rice Mahāprabhu's joy increased, and to feed His devotees He took five of the pots.

207 Seven pots He gave back to the pūjārī, and the other five He shared with His four companions, a pot for each.[64]

208 In His form as Gopīnātha He had already eaten this sweet rice, yet to show what devotion is, He ate it as prasāda.[65]

209 He passed that night in *nāma-saṅkīrtana*, and in the morning, after seeing the *maṅgala-ārati*, He set out.

210 Thus in this narrative He told of the glory of both: the Lord's affection for His devotees, and the love of a devotee that has reached its utmost limit.[66]

211 With His devotees, and with His own holy lips, the Lord relished the glories of Gopāla, Gopīnātha and Purī Gosāñi.

212 Whoever hears this with faith attains the treasure of love at the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

213 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. Heading in the edition: “Obeisance to Mādhavendra Purī, the servant of ‘Kṣīra-corā Gopīnātha’”. *Anubhāṣya*: Gopīnātha — the famous Deity of the village of Remuṇā; Śrī Gopāla, the Holder of Govardhana — the Deity installed by Vajra; Mādhavendra Purī — the disciple of Lakṣmīpati, a guru of the Madhva sampradāya. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 4.2, except that the first line here has *gauracandra* in place of *śrī-caitanya*; translation as there, with that name. ↩
3. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya-khaṇḍa, chapters 2 and 3. ↩
4. *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the original title of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (cf. Ādi 8.33–35). ↩
5. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *dānī* — the ferrymen at the river crossings (to verse 153: those who take the toll for the crossing). *Anubhāṣya*: in Remuṇā dwells the Deity of Gopīnātha, and the samādhi of Rasikānanda Prabhu, the servant of Śyāmānanda Prabhu, is still there. ↩
6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Remuṇā is a village five miles west of Bāleśvara; there Kṣīra-corā Gopīnātha resides. ↩
7. Heading in the edition: the Lord stays there to honour the *kṣīra-prasāda*, which, as He had heard from His guru, awakens the memory of Kṛṣṇa’s love for His devotees. ↩
8. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *mādhava-purī lāgi’*, without the genitive ending. ↩
9. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Mādhava Purī is Mādhavendra Purī. ↩
10. *Anubhāṣya*: *śaila* — the hill of Govardhana, eight *krośas* from Mathurā. ↩
11. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *bhoga-śoṣa* — the desire to eat. ↩
12. Heading in the edition: “The boy hides who He is”. ↩
13. Heading in the edition: “Having given the milk, the boy disappears”. ↩

14. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *bāṭa* — the path, a word of the language of Utkala. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: *bāhya-vṛtti-laya* — he was absorbed in the *samādhi* of bhakti; this was not ordinary sleep. ↩
16. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *kāḍha* — take out; *maṭha* — a temple. ↩
17. Heading in the edition: “Bhagavān waits for His devotee”. ↩
18. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Vajra was the son of Aniruddha, Śrī Kṛṣṇa’s grandson; the Pāṇḍavas brought him from Dvārakā and made him king in Mathurā, and Śrī Gopāla, the Holder of Govardhana, is one of the Deities he installed. ↩
19. *Anubhāṣya* (to verses 47–169): all this effort is for Kṛṣṇa’s pleasure; it is not an attempt to enjoy material objects. ↩
20. *Nava* here means “new” (cf. *nava-pātre*, 65; *nava-vastra*, 72, 81); the nine hundred pots are in verse 56. ↩
21. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *aṅgamalā*, “the dirt of the body”; another reading is *amaṅgalā*, “what is inauspicious”. *Anubhāṣya*: following the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, the dirt is removed by rubbing with pulse flour and with brushes, and then the Lord is carefully anointed with fine fragrant oils (*abhyaṅga*). ↩
22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *pañca-gavya* — milk, yogurt, ghee, cow’s urine and cow dung; *pañcāmṛta* — yogurt, milk, ghee, honey and sugar. *Anubhāṣya*: according to the *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa*, in the *mahā-snāna* the Deity is bathed with ghee, two thousand *palas* each of ghee and of water. ↩
23. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *śaṅkha-gandhodaka* — water poured into a conch and made fragrant with flowers and sandal. ↩
24. *Anubhāṣya* (to verses 69–75): here we see how skilled the author, Śrīla Kavirāja Gosvāmī, is in every kind of cooking. ↩
25. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *māṭhā* — buttermilk; *śikhariṇī* is made by mixing yogurt, milk, sugar, camphor and pepper; *mathani* — fresh butter (*navanīta* and *haiyaṅgava*). ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: *annakūṭa* — a mountain of rice (*anna*); *kūṭa* — a fort, a peak, a mountain. ↩
27. Heading in the edition: “Though Gopāla ate all the offering, at the touch of His hand everything became full again”. ↩
28. Heading in the edition: “The pastimes of Bhagavān are open only to the devotee”. *Anubhāṣya*: see Ādi 3.86–89. ↩
29. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *viḍaka* — rolls of betel; *sañcaya* — a store. ↩

30. *Anubhāṣya*: the Annakūṭa of old — at the end of the Dvāpara-yuga, on Śrī Kṛṣṇa's advice, the cowherds gave up the worship of Indra and honoured the cows, the brāhmaṇas and Govardhana Hill, and Kṛṣṇa, assuming another form and saying "I am the hill", ate the abundant offerings (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.24). *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: just such a great Annakūṭa as at that worship of Govardhana Mādhavendra Purī also held. ↩
31. Heading in the edition: "By Purī's mercy the brāhmaṇas became Vaiṣṇavas". ↩
32. *Anubhāṣya*: *gavya* — milk. ↩
33. Heading in the edition: "The natural love of the people of Vraja and Kṛṣṇa for one another". ↩
34. Heading in the edition: "Purī shows mercy to two renounced brāhmaṇas and entrusts the service to them". ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: *malayaja* — born in the land of Malaya (Malabar, the southern part of the Western Ghats, also called Candana-giri, "the sandal mountain"); the word *malayaja* also means sandalwood itself. Heading in the edition: "In a dream Gopāla tells Purī that He wants sandal". ↩
36. *Anubhāṣya*: Advaita Prabhu received the initiation mantra from Śrī Mādhavendra Purī, the king of ascetics (*yatirāja*), a guru of the Madhva sampradāya. ↩
37. Heading in the edition: "Taking this desire to be an urge of the tongue, Purī is ashamed". ↩
38. Heading in the edition: "Purī's conduct". *Anubhāṣya*: this is the natural (*sahaja*) state of a paramahaṁsa — he delighted in the name of Kṛṣṇa and was indifferent to everything material. ↩
39. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads *ṭhākurera śayana* (genitive; ed *ṭhākure śayana*); the sense is the same. ↩
40. Heading in the edition: "Purī honours the sweet-rice prasāda, not to please his own senses". ↩
41. Heading in the edition: "Purī fears fame"; fear of fame is the theme of verses 141–148. ↩
42. Heading in the edition: "The news of Purī's arrival spreads everywhere". ↩
43. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: fame, ordained by the Creator (*vidhātā*), comes to the one who does good without desiring fame, and does not come to the one who seeks it — this is the secret of fame. *Anubhāṣya* (on 146–147): Vaiṣṇavas do not ask for worldly fame; Mādhavendra tried to hide the incident that showed how dear he was to Bhagavān, yet the highest fame rightly belongs to him. ↩

44. *Anubhāṣya*: wishing to escape the grip of fame, Mādhavendra Purī looked for a way to flee, but the service of Gopāla — collecting the sandalwood — held him in Nīlācala. ↩
45. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* (on 151–152): the camphor is *śrī-karpūra*, used in the ārati of Śrī Jagannātha; the servants of Jagannātha obtained it, and the Malaya sandalwood, from the king's officials. ↩
46. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *ghāṭī* are the *ghāṭwāls* who collect the road toll, *dānī* those who take the fee at river crossings (cf. 12); the royal letter (*rāja-lekhā*, a *parwāna*) let Purī Gosāñi pass without paying them. ↩
47. Gopāla accepts what was brought as already offered to Him. The address is *mādhava*, as in 39. ↩
48. *Anubhāṣya* (on 159–160): Gopāla did not wear the sandalwood Himself but had it put on Gopīnātha, who is non-different from Him: Vṛndāvana is far, the road passes through lands ruled by *mlecchas*, and Gopāla, who loves His devotees, lightened Purī's labour (cf. 176–177). ↩
49. The words *amṛta-carita* ("nectarean life") and *āsvādita* ("relished") are those of the chapter's colophon (*carita-āsvādana*) and of verse 211. ↩
50. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* (on 176–177): beyond the kingdom of Utkala almost the whole country was under a *mleccha* king, whose spies took valuables from travellers, and camphor and sandalwood are rare in Gauḍa. Heading in the edition: "Why Gopīnātha, not Gopāla, wore the sandalwood". ↩
51. *Anubhāṣya*: separation from Kṛṣṇa (*vipralambha*) is the one sādhana of the jīva; Śrīpāda Mādhavendra's matchless desire to please Kṛṣṇa is the model for everyone who longs to serve Kṛṣṇa, and Mahāprabhu and His intimate associates later showed the same. ↩
52. *Anubhāṣya*: *grāmya-vārtā* — worldly talk, all that pleases one's own senses and kindles worldly desire (cf. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.25.25–29). ↩
53. A *krośa* is about two miles. Heading in the edition: "The wonderful perseverance of Purī, who had not a penny, in carrying out the order of the One he served". ↩
54. A maund is about 37 kg, a *tolā* about 11.7 g. ↩
55. *Dānī* — a ferryman, as in 12 and 153; *rākhe* — "detained" (*Anubhāṣya*); the royal letter is the one given to him in 153. ↩
56. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *jagāti* — the *jagāits*, who keep watch on the roads in the guise of guards. ↩
57. Heading in the edition: "The mark of one who loves Kṛṣṇa". *Anubhāṣya*: sufferings and obstacles do not stop those who love deeply; rather, it is amid

them that their love is fully revealed (cf. Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.8; Śikṣāṣṭaka, 8). ↩

58. Heading in the edition: “Kṛṣṇa tests His devotee, and the devotee passes the test”. ↩
59. Heading in the edition: “The unworldly love (*rati*) of the devotee and Bhagavān for each other”. ↩
60. *Malayaja* — sandal from the Malaya hills (see the note on 106). ↩
61. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: only three have relished this verse — Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī, Mādhavendra Purī and Mahāprabhu; no fourth was worthy to relish it. ↩
62. The source, by the heading in the edition: “*tathāhi padyāvalīte catuḥśatāṅka-dhṛta mādhavendrapurī-vākya*” — “the words of Mādhavendra Purī, given in the *Padyāvalī* as number 400”. The verse is quoted again in Antya 8. It is Śrī Rādhā’s speech (194), hence the capitals, as in Madhya 1.58. *Anubhāṣya*: *ayi* is the tender address of the daughter of King Vṛṣabhānu to her Beloved; the wretched are the gopīs, tormented by separation; “Lord of Mathurā” is a reproach: forgetting the gopīs, You delight the women of Mathurā. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: with this verse Mādhavendra Purī sowed the seed of bhakti full of *śṛṅgāra-rasa* — worship in the mood of Śrīmatī Rādhikā’s separation from Kṛṣṇa, who has gone to Mathurā; hence the mahājanas call Mādhavendra Purī the root of the tree of *śṛṅgāra-rasa*, Īśvara Purī its sprout and Mahāprabhu its trunk. ↩
63. *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu*): *jāḍya* is the loss of discernment caused by hearing and seeing what is desired and undesired, by separation and the like; it occurs both before and after swooning (*moha*). ↩
64. Heading in the edition: “The Lord and four others, headed by Nitāi, honour the prasāda”. ↩
65. *Anubhāṣya*: though Mahāprabhu, in the form of Śrī Gopīnātha, had already eaten this sweet rice, as the teacher of the world He honoured the mahā-prasāda to show what worship of Kṛṣṇa is. ↩
66. *Kahilā* is the honorific third person: it is Mahāprabhu, who told the story in 170–190, not the author. Heading in the edition: “This narrative reveals the matchless love of the Lord and His devotee for each other, and the greatness of their qualities”. ↩